“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 11

The Description of Śrī Haridāsa’s Departure

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 I bow to Haridāsa and to his Lord, Caitanya, who took the body of the departed Haridāsa on His lap and danced.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to the all-merciful Lord! Glory to Him who is dear to Advaita and dear to Nityānanda!

3 Glory to the Lord of Śrīnivāsa, the master of Haridāsa! Glory to Him who is dear to Gadādhara, the Lord of Svarūpa’s life!

4 Glory to Him who is dear to Kāśīśvara, the Lord of Jagadānanda’s life! Glory to the Lord of Rūpa, Sanātana and Raghunātha![2]

5 Glory to Kṛṣṇa of golden form, the Supreme Lord Himself! O Lord, be merciful and grant me the shelter of Your feet.[3]

6 Glory to Nityānandacandra, the life of Caitanya! Grant me devotion to Your lotus feet.

7 Glory to Advaitacandra, whom Caitanya honours! Glory to Advaitācārya! Grant me devotion to Your feet.

8 Glory to all the devotees of Gaura, whose very life is Gaura! All you devotees, together grant me devotion.

9 Glory to Rūpa, Sanātana, Jīva, Raghunātha, Raghunātha and Gopāla! These six are the lords of my life.

10 By the mercy of them all I write of the pastimes and qualities of Śrī Caitanya. However I may write, I do it to purify myself.[4]

11 Thus Mahāprabhu lived in Nīlācala, enjoying the pastimes of kīrtana with His devotees.

12 By day He danced and sang kīrtana and beheld Lord Jagannātha; by night He relished rasa with Rāya and Svarūpa.[5]

13 So Mahāprabhu's days passed happily, and in His body many transformations of separation from Kṛṣṇa appeared.

14 Day by day these transformations grew, and at night they became intense: anxiety, agitation, delirious talk and all the others the scriptures describe.

15 Svarūpa Gosāñi and Rāmānanda Rāya, the two of them, attended the Lord day and night.

16 One day Govinda took mahā-prasāda and joyfully went to give it to Haridāsa.

17 He saw that Haridāsa Ṭhākura was lying down, very slowly chanting his fixed number of names.

18 Govinda said, "Get up, come and eat." Haridāsa replied, "Today I shall fast.

19 My counted chanting is not complete; how can I eat? Yet you have brought mahā-prasāda; how can I disregard it?”

20 Saying this, he bowed down to the mahā-prasāda, took a single particle (*rañca*) of it and ate it.

21 The next day Mahāprabhu came to him and asked, “Haridāsa, are you well?”

22 He bowed down and replied, “My body is well, but my mind and intelligence are not.”

23 The Lord said, “What is the illness? Tell Me exactly.” He said, “I cannot complete my counted chanting.”

24 The Lord said, “You have grown old; reduce the number of your names. You are ever perfect, even in body (*siddha-deha*); why are you so intent on sādhana?[6]

25 You have descended to deliver the people, and you have preached the glory of the holy name in the world.[7]

26 Now chant a smaller number of names.” Haridāsa said, “Please hear my request.

27 I was born in a low caste, and my body is contemptible. I am given to low deeds — I am the lowest of wretches.

28 I am unfit to be seen or touched, yet You accepted me. You snatched me out of the hell of Raurava and raised me up to Vaikuṇṭha.

29 You are the independent Lord and act as You will. You make the world dance — each one as You please.

30 By Your grace You have made me dance in many ways: though a *mleccha*, I ate the *śrāddha* plate meant for brāhmaṇas.[8]

31 For many days I have had one desire. My heart tells me that You will soon wind up Your pastimes.

32 Lord, never let me see that pastime. Let my body fall before You.[9]

33 I shall hold Your lotus feet to my heart and gaze with my eyes upon Your moonlike face.

34 With my tongue I shall utter Your name, “Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.” This is my desire — to give up my life in this way.

35 If by Your grace this desire can be fulfilled, then grant my prayer, O merciful Lord.

36 Let this low body of mine fall before You. The fulfilment of this desire depends on You alone.”

37 The Lord said, “Haridāsa, whatever you ask, merciful Kṛṣṇa will surely grant.

38 But whatever happiness I have, I have it all with you. It is not fitting for you to go away and leave Me.”

39 Clasping His feet, Haridāsa said, “Lord, do not try Your *māyā* on me! Do show this mercy (*dayā*) to one so fallen.[10]

40 There are so many great souls, crest jewels far above me; millions of devotees assist in Your pastimes.

41 If one insect like me is gone, what does it matter? When an ant dies, what does the earth lose?

42 You are affectionate to Your devotees (*bhakata-vatsala*), and I am a mere semblance of a devotee. Surely, Lord, You will fulfil this hope of mine."

43 The Lord then went to perform His midday duties, promising that the next day, after seeing Jagannātha, He would come to give Haridāsa His darśana.

44 Mahāprabhu embraced him and went to the sea to perform His midday duties.

45 In the morning, after seeing Jagannātha, He hurried with all the devotees to see Haridāsa.

46 Coming before Haridāsa, the Lord gave him darśana, and Haridāsa bowed to the feet of the Lord and of the Vaiṣṇavas.

47 The Lord said, "Haridāsa, what news?" Haridāsa said, "Lord, as You command."

48 In the courtyard the Lord began a great saṅkīrtana, in which Vakreśvara Paṇḍita danced.

49 Svarūpa Gosāñi and all the Lord's other associates surrounded Haridāsa and sang the holy name.

50 Before Rāmānanda, Sārvabhauma and all the others, the Lord began to speak of Haridāsa's qualities.

51 As He told of Haridāsa's qualities, the Lord became as if five-mouthed, and the more He spoke, the greater His joy grew.

52 Haridāsa's qualities filled everyone's mind with wonder, and all the devotees bowed to his feet.

53 Haridāsa seated the Lord in front of himself and fixed his eyes, like two bees, on the lotus of His face.

54 He brought the Lord's feet to his heart and held them there; the dust of the feet of all the devotees adorned his head.

55 Again and again he said, "Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Prabhu!" He drank in the sweetness of the Lord's face, and streams of tears flowed from his eyes.

56 And so, as he uttered the words "Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya," he let his life go forth from his body together with the name.[11]

57 Like a great master of yoga, he departed at his own will, and everyone remembered the departure of Bhīṣma.[12]

58 Everyone raised a tumult with the sounds "Hari!" and "Kṛṣṇa!", and Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with the bliss of love.

59 Lifting Haridāsa's body onto His lap, the Lord danced in the courtyard, absorbed in love.[13]

60 The Lord's ecstasy overpowered all the devotees; absorbed in love, they all danced and sang kīrtana.

61 In this way the Lord danced for some time; then Svarūpa Gosāñi made a request to Him.

62 They placed Haridāsa Ṭhākura on a *vimāna*, a palanquin shaped like a celestial chariot, and carried him to the sea, singing kīrtana.

63 Mahāprabhu went in front, dancing all the way, and behind Him Vakreśvara danced with the devotees.

64 He bathed Haridāsa in the water of the sea and said, “This sea has now become a great holy place (*mahā-tīrtha*).”

65 The devotees drank the water that had washed Haridāsa’s feet and anointed his body with prasāda sandal paste.

66 They placed on his body *ḍora* (silk cords), *kaḍāra* (sandal paste), prasāda and cloth; then, making a pit in the sand, they laid him in it.[14]

67 On all sides the devotees sang kīrtana, and Vakreśvara Paṇḍita danced in bliss.

68 Calling “Hari bol! Hari bol!”, Gaurarāya Himself put sand on Haridāsa’s body with His holy hands.

69 When they had covered him with sand, they had a platform built over him and a great enclosure made around it.

70 Then Mahāprabhu sang kīrtana and danced, and the tumult of Hari’s name filled the world.

71 Afterwards Mahāprabhu bathed in the sea with all the devotees and joyfully played in the water.

72 After circumambulating Haridāsa, He came to the Lion Gate, and the tumult of Hari’s kīrtana filled the whole city.

73 Coming to the Lion Gate, the Lord spread out the end of His cloth before the shopkeepers and begged them for prasāda:[15]

74 “I am begging prasāda for the festival of Haridāsa Ṭhākura. Please give Me alms.”

75 Hearing this, all the shopkeepers joyfully lifted up their big baskets (*cāṅgaḍā*) and came to give prasāda.

76 Svarūpa Gosāñi stopped them, and the shopkeepers sat down again in their shops with their baskets.

77 Svarūpa Gosāñi sent the Lord home and kept with him four Vaiṣṇavas and four porters (*pichāḍā*).[16]

78 Svarūpa Gosāñi said to all the shopkeepers, “Give me one *puñjā* (a portion counted by fours) of each item.”

79 In this way he had all kinds of prasāda tied into bundles, put them on the heads of the four men and brought them back.

80 Vāṇīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka brought prasāda, and Kāśī Miśra sent a great quantity.

81 The Lord seated all the Vaiṣṇavas in rows and began to serve them Himself, with four helpers.

82 A small amount would not come into Mahāprabhu’s holy hand: on each leaf He served enough food for five.

83 Svarūpa said, “Lord, sit down and watch. I shall serve with these helpers.”

84 Svarūpa, Jagadānanda, Kāśīśvara and Śaṅkara — these four served without pause.

85 Since the Lord had not eaten, no one would eat. That day the Lord had an invitation from Kāśī Miśra.

86 Kāśī Miśra came himself with prasāda and pressed the Lord to take His meal.

87 The Lord took His meal with Purī and Bhāratī, and then all the Vaiṣṇavas ate.

88 He had them eat until they were filled to the throat, the Lord repeating, “Give more! Give more!”

89 When everyone had eaten and performed *ācamana*, the Lord adorned them all with garlands and sandal paste.

90 Absorbed in love, the Lord bestowed a boon, and the devotees, hearing it, found their hearts’ desire fulfilled.

91–93 “Whoever saw the festival of Haridāsa’s departure, whoever danced here or sang kīrtana, whoever went to put sand on him, and whoever among them ate at the festival — all of them will soon attain Kṛṣṇa. Such is the power of seeing Haridāsa.[17]

94 Out of mercy Kṛṣṇa gave Me Haridāsa’s company. Kṛṣṇa’s will is independent: now He has broken that company.

95 When Haridāsa wished to go, My power could not keep him.

96 By his wish alone he sent his life forth from his body, as we have heard Bhīṣma did long ago.

97 Haridāsa was the crest jewel of the earth; without him the earth has been robbed of its jewel."

98 "Call out 'Glory, glory to Haridāsa!' and raise the sound of Hari's name!" Saying this, Mahāprabhu Himself began to dance.

99 Everyone sang, "Glory, glory, glory to Haridāsa, who revealed the glory of the holy name!"

100 Then Mahāprabhu bade farewell to all the devotees and rested, in both joy and sorrow.[18]

101 Thus I have told of Haridāsa's departure (*vijaya*); by hearing of it one gains firm devotion to Kṛṣṇa.[19]

102 From this we know Caitanya's affection for His devotees: He, the crest jewel of sannyāsīs, fulfilled His devotee's desire.

103 At his last hour the Lord let him see and touch Him, and taking him on His lap, He Himself danced.

104 In His mercy He Himself put sand on him with His holy hands, and He Himself begged prasāda and held a great festival.

105 Haridāsa was a *mahā-bhāgavata* and supremely learned (*parama-vidvān*); for the sake of this good fortune he departed before the Lord.[20]

106 These deeds of Caitanya are an ocean of nectar; a single drop of it satisfies the ears and the mind.[21]

107 Whoever has set his heart on crossing the ocean of worldly existence should hear with faith this account of Caitanya.

108 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: *saṁsthitām* — gone into *samādhi*. Heading in the edition: obeisance to Gaura, who danced holding Haridāsa's body in His arms. ↩
2. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *kāśīśvara-priya*, "dear to Kāśīśvara" (a disciple of Īśvara Purī and servant of Mahāprabhu; cf. verse 84); some editions read *kāśī-priya*. ↩
3. *Gaura-deha* qualifies Kṛṣṇa. *Anubhāṣya*: *gaura-deha* — He whose body has a golden lustre. ↩
4. The first line is the same as Ādi 9.5; translated as there. ↩
5. The second line is the same as Antya 9.6. Heading in the edition: at night, with Svarūpa and Rāmānanda, the Lord relishes the rasa of Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa. ↩
6. Heading in the edition: the Lord tells Haridāsa, whose body is perfect and not of this world, to lessen the sādhana that he only enacts as an example (*sādhana-abhinaya*). ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: by the Lord's will His devotees and associates descend to the earth to serve Him. ↩
8. See Antya 3.220. *Anubhāṣya*: by the smṛti the *śrāddha* plate is not given even to a brāhmaṇa by birth if he is unworthy; here the plate meant for a pure brāhmaṇa was given to Haridāsa, a brāhmaṇa by initiation: though born among *mlecchas*, he had the right to it as a servant of Hari (*hari-jana*). ↩
9. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "that pastime" — the pastime of Your disappearance (*antardhāna-līlā*). Heading in the edition: Haridāsa wishes to end his pastimes before the Lord's departure. ↩
10. Heading in the edition: Haridāsa begs the Lord for mercy without guile (*niṣkapaṭa*); *māyā* here is the opposite of *dayā*. ↩
11. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *utkrāmaṇa* — going out, departure. Heading in the edition: seeing the Lord before him and chanting His name, the Ṭhākura departs — *niryāṇa*, or *utkrānti*. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: on Bhīṣma's departure see Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.9.29–43. Heading in the edition: all remember how in the Dvāpara age Bhīṣma departed by his own will. ↩

13. Heading in the edition: the Lord dances holding Haridāsa's body, which is not of this world. ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: *ḍora* — silk cords (*paṭṭa-ḍorī*), the prasāda of Śrī Jagannātha; *kaḍāra* — sandal paste, prasāda. ↩
15. Heading in the edition: for the festival of separation from Haridāsa (*viraha-mahotsava*) the Lord Himself begs prasāda from the shopkeepers at the Lion Gate. ↩
16. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *pichāḍā* — people who walk behind; according to others, a basket or load (cf. verse 79). ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: *vijayotsava* — the festival of separation (*viraha-mahotsava*). ↩
18. Heading in the edition: He had seen both the separation from His devotee and the glory of his departure (*vijaya*). ↩
19. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Haridāsa Ṭhākura's *samādhi* still stands by the sea, on the way from Ṭoṭā-Gopīnātha to the shore; his departure is celebrated every year on Ananta-caturdaśī. ↩
20. Cf. verse 32. *Anubhāṣya*: *parama-vidvān* — one perfect in the highest knowledge, the knowledge of Kṛṣṇa; by Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.24, truly learned is he who performs kīrtana, the best of the nine limbs of bhakti. ↩
21. The first line is the same as Madhya 18.228. ↩